



the basic
argument



allowable
evils

A large, solid orange circle serves as the background for the text.

what is
omnipotence?

the
argument
reformulated

The second, which is our topic for the next few classes, tries to show that the idea that God is all-powerful and all-good contradicts a very obvious fact about the world: the fact that it contains evil. This is by far the most important argument for atheism.

There are two especially important arguments against belief in God.

The first is based on the (alleged) lack of evidence for God's existence, and the rule that one should not believe things without a basis in evidence.

We'll turn to that one later in the course.

What do we mean by 'evil'?

For our purposes, an evil is just some feature of the world that the world would be (everything else equal) better off without.

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any possible

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is important, it

2; If something





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1. If God exists, then God is

2. If something is on it,

elinites all point less vii.

3. If God exists, then God can

4. If God exists, then God is

it always initiates as much

do anything. (1,2)

prints it as it can.



5*. If something is wholly good,

8. If God exists, then there is

(3,6)

no point less evi1. (7)

elinitatesas much printless

evil as God said. (4,5)

9*. Some principles exist.

6. If God exists, then God

it can do anything.



7. If God exists, then God

C. God does not exist. (8,9)

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9*. Some points less

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So attention naturally focuses on premise (5).



good, it always reminds

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